A-A-51876A
8 May 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051876(DM)
21 APRIL 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, THORACIC (Harrington)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a right angled thoracic forceps (clamp) of the Harrington design suitable for use in thoracic surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The forceps shall be in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Designation Standard F1026 except as specified herein.

Material. The material of the forceps shall be Class 4 martensitic stainless steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F899.

Hardness. Forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 45 to 50. The hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

Style and design. Forceps shall be in accordance with Figure 1. The distal 1/2 inch of the jaws shall have cross serrations perpendicular to the longitudinal serrations. The forceps shall be in accordance with all design requirements of ASTM Designation F1026.

Finish. The finish of the forceps shall be satin or matte. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Passivation. As a final finishing operating, the forceps shall be properly passivated.

Markings. In addition to the requirements of ASTM Designation F1026, forceps shall be permanently marked with the word "stainless."

Corrosion resistance. The forceps shall show no signs of corrosion when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility, or appearance.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-116-1050	FORCEPS, THORACIC, Right-Angled, Harrington, 1-1/4 Inch Jaws

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 47185

Project No. 6515-4574

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

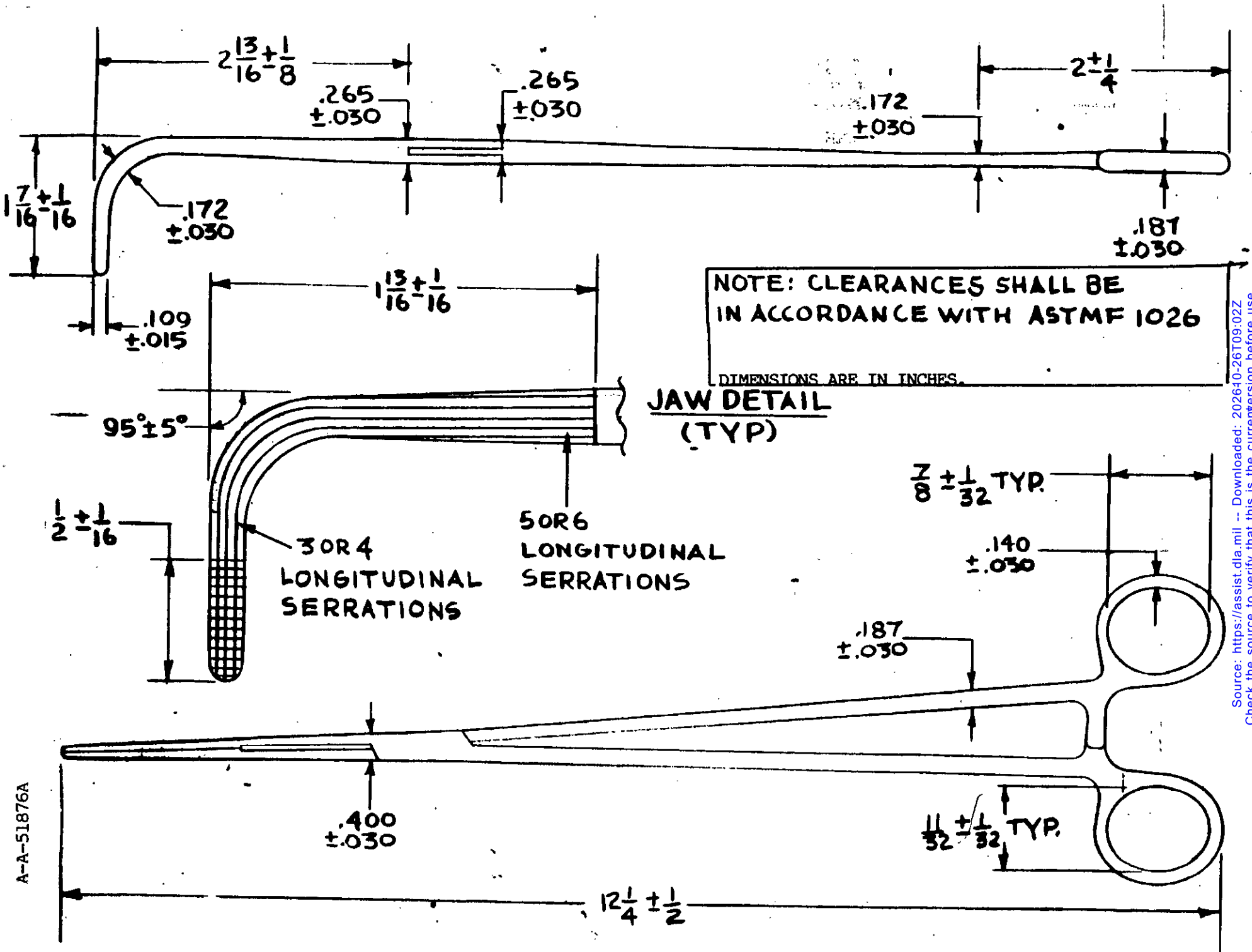


FIGURE 1 FORCEPS, THORACIC HARRINGTON

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.